

Chapter 87-4

Before long, Liang Xinzhou came downstairs after finishing his meeting. Upon seeing Liang Shi, he only nodded slightly without showing much affection. You could only detect some clues from his usually calm and unperturbed eyes—he was happy, because his pupils were bright.

Liang Shi didn't have much to chat with him about either. Talking too much about Liang family matters would easily make one sad, and she had now clearly positioned herself as someone outside the Liang family, so she kept her mouth shut about Liang family affairs.

She only asked if he still planned to return to Dongheng.

Liang Xinzhou's answer was very zen¹. "I'll go with the flow."

Liang Shi understood. The deeper meaning behind these words was: it depends on whether the Liang family still needs him.

If they needed him enough, Liang Xinzhou would still go back.

"By the way," Liang Shi said, "Second Brother asked me to contact you. I refused and ignored him."

"Well done." Liang Xinzhou nonchalantly pushed the plate of fried milk² toward her. "He's pretty busy right now too. Don't take up his time."

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Shi couldn't help but laugh.

"What are you laughing at?" Liang Xinzhou asked.

Liang Shi teased, "Big Brother, I can't believe you're being passive-aggressive toward Second Brother."

Liang Xinzhou glanced at her. "I'm telling the truth."

"Second Brother is having a rough time now too." Liang Shi shook her head. "Busy to death all by himself. He's probably about to explode."

"He brought it on himself," Liang Xinzhou said. "He should think about when I've ever harmed him."

There was a trace of resentment in Liang Xinzhou's voice as he said this.

Liang Shi comforted him. "Don't you know him best? Second Brother just has a soft personality. Isn't Second Sister-in-law the same? They're both good people. They must be feeling caught in the middle right now."

"This is also a lesson for him." Liang Xinzhou lowered his eyes. "There aren't that many win-win situations in this world."

Liang Shi deeply understood this and agreed.

Actually, Liang Shi had thought that conflicts would erupt in the Liang family because of Guo Xinran's arrival. After all, before Guo Xinran came, the one who strutted around that household was the original owner.

No matter how unruly and violent the original owner's personality was, she wouldn't bully her own family members. When Liang Xinzhou scolded her, at most she would let it go in one ear and out the other. She wouldn't hold grudges or seek revenge, and she wouldn't even complain to Qiu Zimin, who always favored her, to have Qiu Zimin seek justice for her.

The same went for Qiu Zimin.

No matter how much she favored the original owner, she wouldn't cause trouble for her eldest son, whom she had always been proud of, because of the original owner. Even if she heard Liang Xinzhou lecturing Liang Shi, she would at most chime in with a word or two from the side.

But Guo Xinran's return was different. Even though she was very well-behaved and the whole family accommodated her, with a large family living together—with children and a pregnant woman—who should yield to whom?

It was hard to reach a conclusion.

It was inherently difficult for a newcomer to integrate into a new environment, and there was no way to please everyone.

Either everyone moved out, or they didn't acknowledge the family ties.

Otherwise, conflicts would erupt sooner or later.

As it turned out, Guo Xinran stepped on a landmine on her very first day.

Liang Shi could only say that Liang Xinzhou had turned misfortune into fortune.

He had found the perfect excuse to move out of the old residence, making it convenient for Yu Wan to focus on her pregnancy.

After eating at Liang Xinzhou's place, Liang Xinzhou asked her about some work matters. Liang Shi gave him a brief explanation, and Liang Xinzhou nodded with a half-understanding.

These weren't within Liang Xinzhou's area of expertise, but Liang Xinzhou had previously acquired a talent agency. He urged Liang Shi to make sure she assembled a professional team, otherwise it would be too exhausting to handle everything alone.

After saying all this, Liang Xinzhou also asked her to relay a few words to Xu Qingzhu.

Liang Shi was completely clueless about these matters, so she directly typed them into a note and sent it to Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu immediately replied: Who told you this???

Liang Shi answered honestly: 【Big Brother.】

Xu Qingzhu: Thank Big Brother for me.

Liang Shi only learned afterward from Xu Qingzhu that the advice Liang Xinzhou had sent would play a crucial role in Minghui Jewelry's later operations.

Because those were all the pitfalls Dongheng had encountered when expanding and going public. As a similar company with overlapping business areas, the path Minghui needed to take was the same path Dongheng had already walked.

It was only then that Liang Shi realized Liang Xinzhou's selfless love for her as a younger sister.

It was a love that transcended blood ties.

Yet at this moment, Liang Shi was like an emotionless message-relaying machine.

As Liang Shi was about to leave, Liang Xinzhou gave her a key, along with the door lock password and a bank card.

Liang Shi: "?"

"What's this for?" Liang Shi waved her hand in refusal. "I really don't want it. Didn't I already say so last time?"

"Take it." Liang Xinzhou frowned. "I've already had the property transferred to your name. From now on, it's your house."

Liang Shi: "..."

"I didn't give you a gift when you got married," Liang Xinzhou said. "Consider this your wedding present."

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Xinzhou seemed to be making up for the mistakes Qiu Zimin had made.

Because Qiu Zimin had sold the Shallow Bay villa, Liang Xinzhou wanted to give her back a house.

This realization made Liang Shi's heart skip a beat.

The reason she had initially wanted to keep her distance from the Liang brothers was because she thought that no matter what, they were both Qiu Zimin's biological sons. Even if they knew about the things Qiu Zimin had done, they would at most feel uncomfortable about it, but blood ties couldn't be severed. For Liang Shi, however, it was different.

She very much wanted to expose everything Qiu Zimin had done to the world.

The darkness and hatred that Qiu Zimin had inflicted on a young girl—the obsessive desire to drive her insane—Liang Shi wanted to return it all.

She had even thought that the cruelest thing would be to drive Qiu Zimin insane.

Footnotes:

¹ **Zen (佛系, fó xì):** A popular Chinese internet slang term literally meaning "Buddhist style." It describes a calm, detached attitude toward life—not competing, not forcing things, and accepting whatever happens. Similar to saying "going with the flow" or being very laid-back about outcomes.

² **Fried milk (炸牛奶):** A popular Cantonese dessert made by coating solidified milk custard in batter and deep-frying it until golden and crispy on the outside while remaining soft and creamy inside.